

# MODES SUCK!

## FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #51

Modes have caused a lot of mental pain and anguish in the world. They've also helped create some great music. So, I guess we better dig in and learn about these dang things!

- #1 - Modes are based on the Major scale. What does that mean? Learn your Major scales.
- #2 - Memorize the "recipe" or "formula" for the modes you are learning. If you are learning the Dorian mode, for instance, learn the formula "1 - 2 - b3 - 4 - 5 - 6 - b7 - 8". This formula is relative to the Major Scale (see #1 above).
- #3 - My advice is to NOT keep referring back to the "original Major scale." For instance, if you are learning the D Dorian scale, DON'T spend too much time thinking about the fact the it's "the 2nd mode of C Major." You are playing D Dorian, so get your head thinking about MINOR sounds. Think "flat 3rds and flat 7ths." Thinking and hearing C Major won't help you to hear D Minor.
- #4 - DON'T learn all the modes. Learn Major (1st mode). Then learn Dorian (2nd mode) and Mixolydian (5th mode). Now you can play a Major ii - V - I.
- #5 - Then learn Lydian (the 4th mode). You'll sound cool on Major 7 chords with the #4!
- #6 - You can die of old age playing good jazz without practicing Phrygian, Aeolian or Locrian. You'll end up playing them and using their sounds eventually, by getting to them in other simpler ways down the road. For today, give yourself a break.

1 **IONIAN** (**MAJOR**) C $\Delta$ 7 D $\Delta$ 7 E $\Delta$ 7 F $\Delta$ 7 G $\Delta$ 7 A $\Delta$ 7 B $\Delta$ 7 C $\Delta$ 7



1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8

2 **DORIAN** (**MINOR**)



1 2 b3 4 5 6 b7 8

3 **PHRYGIAN** (**MINOR**)



1 b2 b3 4 5 b6 b7 8

4 **LYDIAN** (**MAJOR**)



1 2 3 #4 5 6 7 8

5 **MIXOLYDIAN** (**DOMINANT**)



1 2 3 4 5 6 b7 8

6 **AEOLIAN** (**MINOR**)



1 2 b3 4 5 b6 b7 8

7 **LOCRIAN** (**HALF DIMINISHED**)



1 b2 b3 4 b5 b6 b7 8